

The Unshakeable Manager's Guide

How to make clear, confident decisions in the age of AI overwhelm

Still your mind. Sharp your decisions.

A free guide from Chisoku Lab — for mid-level managers who are tired of being the bottleneck in their own careers.

- ◆ Why your brain is working against you right now
- ◆ The ancient concept that changes everything
- ◆ A framework to sort any decision in 60 seconds
- ◆ The one reframe that ends decision fatigue

It's Not You. It's the Invisible Tax.

Let's start with something nobody in your organisation is saying out loud:

"The AI tools that were supposed to free you up are quietly burying you."

Here's what happened. You adopted Slack, then Teams, then a project management tool, then an AI writing assistant, then a meeting summariser, then a code helper. Each one came with a promise: *less work, more clarity, more time for the things that matter.*

And in some ways, each tool delivered. But nobody told you about the hidden tax.

70

decisions/day

Average manager in 2020

120+

Average manager in 2024

15%

feel more productive

Despite the increase

We're working harder. Deciding more. And feeling worse. That's not a personal failure — that's a system problem. And systems can be fixed.

But before we fix it, you need to understand why your brain is struggling. And for that, we need to travel about 700 years back in time.

The Ancient Concept Nobody Taught You in Business School

In 14th-century Japan, Zen Buddhist monks developed a principle called **Chisoku** (知止). Translated literally, it means "knowing enough." But in practice, it means something far more powerful:

"The ability to find stillness and clarity in the present moment — not by having all the answers, but by knowing which questions actually matter."

Samurai leaders — who made life-and-death decisions in the chaos of battle — used Chisoku as a mental operating system. Not to slow down. Not to meditate away their problems. But to cut through noise with ruthless clarity.

Here's what this has to do with your Tuesday afternoon:

STILLNESS

is not inaction. It's the ability to pause before reacting — to choose your response instead of defaulting to one.

CLARITY

is not certainty. It's knowing what decision is actually yours to make, and making it with the information you have.

ENOUGH

is not settling. It's recognising that you already have what you need to make this decision well. You're just spending it in the wrong places.

The Bhagavad Gita puts it differently. In Chapter 2, verse 47, Krishna tells Arjuna — a warrior paralysed by the weight of his decisions on the battlefield:

"You have a right to perform your prescribed duties, but you are not entitled to the fruits of your actions."

— Bhagavad Gita, 2:47

In modern management language: **make the decision that is yours to make, with full commitment, without being paralysed by outcomes you cannot control.**

This is what Chisoku Lab is built on.

Not productivity hacks. Not hustle culture. Not another app to manage your apps. We exist at the intersection of ancient wisdom and modern AI strategy — because the managers who will thrive in the AI era are not the ones who move fastest. They're the ones who think clearest.

The One Reframe That Changes Everything

Most managers facing decision fatigue say the same thing:

"I'm overwhelmed by decisions."

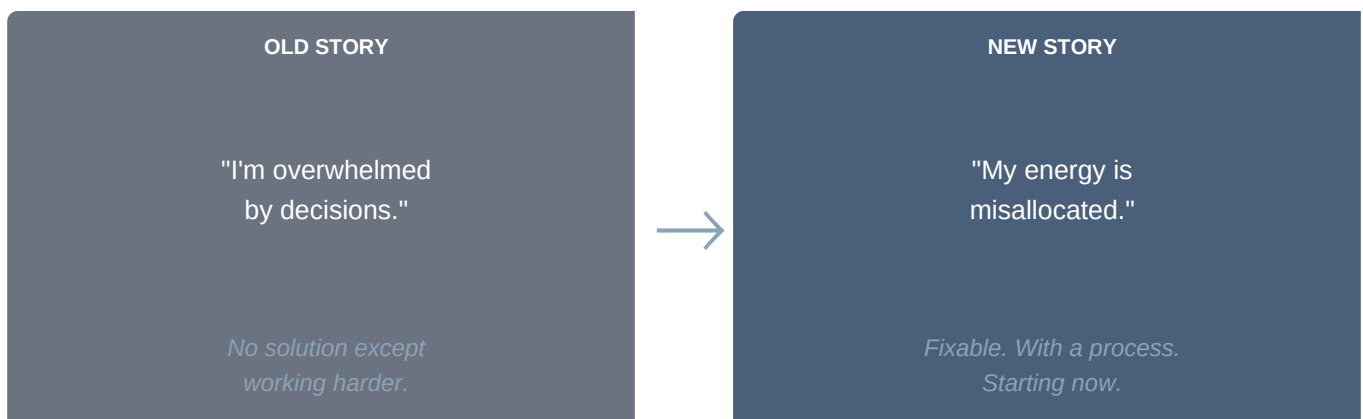
It sounds true. It *feels* true. But it's not the real problem.

The real problem is this:

"Your energy is misallocated."

There is a profound difference between those two statements. **"Overwhelmed"** has no solution except working harder, sleeping more, or burning out more slowly.

"Misallocated" is fixable. It has a process. It has a framework. And it starts with understanding that not all decisions are created equal.



Here is the uncomfortable truth this reframe reveals:

- ❖ **Most of the decisions exhausting you right now are not yours to make.**
You've taken on Type 2 and Type 3 decisions that belong to your team, your tools, or a system.
- ❖ **The decisions that ARE yours — the strategic ones — are getting your worst energy.**
You're making your most important calls when you're already drained from everything else.
- ❖ **The solution is not to make fewer decisions.**
It's to make the right ones — with the right energy — at the right time.

The Three Types Framework

Every decision you face — every single one — falls into one of three categories. Once you see this, you cannot unsee it.

TYPE 1

STRATEGIC

YOU DECIDE

What it is: Requires your unique judgment, context, or authority.

Characteristics: High stakes. Ambiguous. People-dependent. Directional.

Examples:

- Should we adopt AI for this function?
- Who leads the team through this change?
- Do we prioritise speed or quality here?

→ 60–70% of your decision **ENERGY**

TYPE 2

OPERATIONAL

DELEGATE

What it is: Requires judgment — but not YOUR specific judgment.

Characteristics: Has clear parameters. Repeatable. Teachable. Recoverable.

Examples:

- Which vendor proposals advance?
- How should we schedule this project?
- Which bugs get prioritised this sprint?

→ 20–30% of your time (mostly delegated)

TYPE 3

MECHANICAL

AUTOMATE

What it is: Follows clear rules, patterns, or data-driven logic.

Characteristics: No judgment needed. Consistent criteria. High volume.

Examples:

- Routing support tickets
- Approving standard expenses
- Generating weekly reports

→ Approaching 0% of YOUR time

"If you can write down the decision rule, it should not be your decision anymore."

See It In Action

Here is a Slack message that landed in a manager's inbox last Tuesday:

■ **Team Member:** "Should we use ChatGPT or Claude for our customer service automation pilot?"

Feels like a quick question. Two-minute answer. Move on.

Wrong. Run it through the Three Types Framework and watch what happens:

TYPE 1 — STRATEGIC	Do we automate customer service at all? This touches company values, customer experience philosophy, team readiness. This is yours to own.
TYPE 2 — OPERATIONAL	Which use cases should we pilot first? Your customer service lead knows the pain points better than you. Delegate to them.
TYPE 3 — MECHANICAL	What are the feature differences between ChatGPT and Claude? This is research — comparing specs against criteria. Give it to an analyst. Or use AI to research AI.

Result: One Slack message → three properly-categorised decisions → you spent 5 focused minutes on strategy, not 30 minutes in the weeds.

— QUICK WIN —

The 45-Minute Audit That Recovers 6-8 Hours/Week

Before you can fix your energy allocation, you need to see where it's actually going. Most managers think they know. The audit proves them wrong.

Days 1–3 CAPTURE	Log every decision you make. Don't judge. Just capture. Use your phone.
Day 4 CATEGORISE	Mark each decision: Strategic (S), Operational (O), or Mechanical (M).
Day 5 CALCULATE	Estimate time spent on each type. Most managers find 80% misallocated.
Day 5 IDENTIFY	Find your quick wins — decisions to automate, delegate, or eliminate.

Total audit time: **45 minutes**. Time recovered in Week 1: **6–8 hours**. That's a 15x return on investment.

What Unshakeable Actually Looks Like

People misunderstand what it means to be an unshakeable decision-maker. They think it means never doubting yourself. Never feeling the pressure. Always having the right answer.

It doesn't mean any of those things.

"Unshakeable means you have a process that works regardless of how you feel."

The Reactive Manager

- Answers questions as they arrive — in the order of interruption
- Mixes strategic and mechanical thinking in the same hour
- Makes important calls when depleted from routine ones
- Feels busy but not impactful
- Confuses activity with progress

The Unshakeable Manager

The gap between these two managers is not intelligence. It is not experience. It is not even time.

It is a **system**. A repeatable, practised way of engaging with the decisions that land on your desk every day.

The Chisoku approach — still mind, sharp decisions — is not a personality trait you either have or you don't. It is a skill. And like every skill, it is learnable.

"You are not the problem. You are the solution — once you have the right framework."

Ready to Build the Full System?

This guide gave you the foundation — the philosophy, the reframe, and one core framework. But the full Unshakeable Decisions course goes seven modules deep.

01	The Decision Fatigue Crisis	Available Now
02	The Clarity Filter Framework	Available Now
03	The Energy Audit	Coming Soon
04	The Detachment Principle	Coming Soon
05	Building Decision Resilience	Coming Soon
06	Human Decisions in an AI World	Coming Soon
07	The Source — Ancient Wisdom	Coming Soon

Each module builds on the last. Each one comes with downloadable frameworks, fillable worksheets, and tools you can use the same day you watch it.

EARLY BIRD

Rs. 2,999 / \$39 USD

Waitlist price — limited spots

AT LAUNCH

Rs. 4,999 / \$59 USD

Full price — lifetime access

Join the Waitlist

Lock in your Early Bird price and get notified the moment the course goes live.

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